

Section 18

Open Records, Transparency & CCWIS

Version 2.0 — Preliminary Draft

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SECTION 18 — OPEN RECORDS, TRANSPARENCY & CCWIS OVERSIGHT

(Data Acquisition, Provenance & Digital Infrastructure Layer)

Version 2.3 — June 5, 2026

COMPANION REPORT REFERENCE

The complete analytical record of Iowa's CCWIS procurement, IT governance, PHI access controls, federal approval mechanism, and open records transparency failures is contained in:

Iowa CCWIS VISION Oversight & IT Procurement Compliance Report

[CCWIS Companion Report — Living Document, Version 1.1, June 5, 2026]

That report is filed concurrently with this petition and incorporated herein by reference. This section provides the audit-facing summary, the formal open records request index, and the document provenance record required for evidentiary traceability. Reviewers requiring full analytical depth should consult the companion report directly.

18.1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This section documents: (1) the petitioner's formal open records requests and the agency's handling of those requests; (2) the records produced through those requests and their evidentiary significance; (3) the structural transparency failures identified through the records acquisition process; and (4) the analytical findings arising from the produced records regarding Iowa's \$108.8M CCWIS VISION technology investment.

The records acquisition process is itself evidentiary. Iowa is making a \$108.8M federal-state investment in child welfare data infrastructure that

directly governs the accuracy of data submitted to federal oversight bodies for CFSR performance measurement. The structural barriers a private citizen encountered in attempting to access public records about that investment — 60-hour fee estimates, unilateral request closures, a pending request with zero records produced, and a publicly inaccessible IT procurement approval page — are Domain H (data integrity and auditability) findings in their own right.

18.2 OPEN RECORDS REQUEST INDEX

■ Request ■ Filed ■ Agency ■ Subject ■ Status (5/30/2026) ■

■ #26-927 ■ March 5, 2026 ■ Iowa HHS ■ Child welfare systems — ■ OPEN — partial ■

■ ■ ■ ■ funding, oversight, data ■ production only; ■

■■■■ integrity, provider ecosystem ■ fee dispute active; ■

86 days open

■ #26-1536 ■ April 10, 2026 ■ Iowa HHS ■ CCWIS/VISION governance, ■ OPEN — zero records ■

■ ■ ■ ■ data quality controls, audit ■ produced; fee demand■

■ ■ ■ ■ logs, access controls, ■ pending; 50 days ■

■ ■ ■ ■ vendor deliverables ■ open ■

Full correspondence logs: Attachment A42B (ORR #26-927) | Attachment A42D (ORR #26-1536)

Request documents: Attachment A42A (ORR #26-927) | Attachment A42C (ORR #26-1536)

18.3 TRANSPARENCY FINDINGS SUMMARY

The handling of both requests documents a pattern of structural opacity regarding a publicly-funded child welfare technology system. Three headline findings are presented here; full analysis is in the CCWIS Companion Report, Part I.

FINDING 1 — GRADUATED FEE ESCALATION AS ACCESS BARRIER (ORR #26-927)

Iowa HHS initially estimated 60 hours of staff time to fulfill a broad public records request. This estimate was reduced to 39 hours after scope narrowing, and to 11 hours after further narrowing — each reduction triggered by the petitioner's scope adjustments rather than agency reassessment. The three free hours ultimately consumed produced policy manuals and task force notes — documents that should arguably be proactively published on a government website. The substantively significant records (KinderTrack/FACS governance, evaluation summaries, contracted provider oversight) remain fee-gated at the 50% prepayment threshold. Days open as of submission: 86.

FINDING 2 — PARTIAL PRODUCTION / FEE-GATED CONTINUATION (ORR #26-1536)

Iowa HHS produced the CCWIS IAPD, the Google/Carahsoft contract, and three substitute policies (A44–A50) through ORR #26-1536 on April 23, 2026. The same April 23, 2026 response that produced those records contained the explicit admission: "Iowa HHS does not have a Data Governance Policy." Three substitute policies were cited in its place. The agency then estimated 15 additional staff hours at \$32/hour for KinderTrack governance records — requiring 50% prepayment before gathering. The follow-up governance categories (audit trails, access controls, override tracking, system limitations) remain unaddressed. Days open as of submission: 50.

FINDING 3 — 403 ACCESS DENIED ON CIO APPROVAL PROCESS PAGE

The Iowa OCIO/DOM Enterprise IT Standards page (Attachment A51) establishes that all Iowa IT procurements must be approved by the Chief Information Officer and links to the governing approval process document at: <https://ocio.iowa.gov/it-procurement/approval-processes>. As of June 5, 2026, that URL returns HTTP 403 — ACCESS DENIED. The governing document describing how CIO approval is implemented for a \$41.9M child welfare technology contract is not publicly accessible. The public cannot verify whether the approval requirement was satisfied.

18.4 THE CCWIS INVESTMENT — HEADLINE FINDINGS

Iowa has committed \$108.8M in federal and state funds to modernize its child

welfare information infrastructure through the CCWIS VISION project, executed via a \$41.9M contract with Google Public Sector Services and Carahsoft Technology Corporation (Attachment A44). The federal share — \$45,786,250 — was conditionally approved by the ACF Children's Bureau on December 11, 2025 (Attachment A45), based on Iowa's own representations in the Implementation Advance Planning Document (Attachments A49, A50).

Five headline findings arise from the records produced through ORR #26-1536 and analyzed in the CCWIS Companion Report:

(1) NO DATA GOVERNANCE POLICY: Iowa HHS has admitted, in its formal open records response, that it does not have a Data Governance Policy.

The \$108.8M CCWIS investment is being built on a governance framework that does not exist as a formal policy instrument.

(2) CONTRACTOR PHI ACCESS WITHOUT DOCUMENTED VETTING: The Google/Carahsoft contract (A44) does not contain documented background check or fingerprinting requirements for contractor personnel accessing Iowa child welfare protected health information — despite three Iowa HHS policies (A46, A47, A48) establishing such obligations for all contractors.

(3) FEDERAL APPROVAL ON SELF-REPORTED COMPLIANCE: The Children's Bureau conditional approval (A45) was issued on the basis of the state's own IAPD representations — representations that themselves acknowledged outstanding PIPs and data quality failures unresolved at submission date. The same self-reporting structure that failed across three CFSR cycles governs the \$45.8M federal investment approval.

(4) IT JURISDICTIONAL CAPTURE OF FEDERAL OVERSIGHT: Iowa HHS IT Acceptable Use Policy IT23-0082 (A48) establishes that federal CFSR reviewers operating within Iowa HHS IT systems are subject to Iowa HHS monitoring, audit rights, and acceptable use restrictions. The entity under federal oversight governs the data environment in which that oversight is conducted. Cross-reference: Section 7.3(c).

(5) KINDERTRACK INTEGRATION WITHOUT REMEDIATION: The IAPD lists KinderTrack as a future CCWIS VISION interface (A50) — the same system documented in the Harkin Institute analysis (A21) and confirmed by official agency correspondence (A43) as containing verifiable data accuracy failures. No documented remediation of those failures precedes integration.

18.5 RECORDS PRODUCED — DOCUMENT INVENTORY

The following records were produced through ORR #26-1536 and are filed as primary source evidence. All were produced subject to redactions pursuant to Iowa Code § 22.7(50) where indicated.

A44 — Iowa HHS CCWIS VISION Contract — Google/Carahsoft (Redacted)
March 26, 2026 | \$41.9M | NASPO ValuePoint cooperative purchasing vehicle | Contractor personnel vetting provisions absent

A45 — ACF Children's Bureau Conditional Approval of Iowa CCWIS IAPD
December 11, 2025 | \$45,786,250 federal share conditionally approved
| Approval based on state self-representations in A49/A50

A46 — Iowa HHS Confidentiality Policy — COMP23-0111 (2023)
Establishes PHI confidentiality obligations applicable to all contractors — evaluated against A44 in companion report Section 3

A47 — Iowa HHS Data Sharing Policy — HHS-COMP-DSPOR-0043 (2023)
Governs external data access authorization — evaluated against A44

A48 — Iowa HHS IT Acceptable Use Policy — IT23-0082 (2023)
Establishes Iowa HHS IT jurisdiction over all system users including federal reviewers — IT jurisdictional capture finding

A49 — Iowa CCWIS VISION IAPD Part 1 (pp. 1–77) — December 8, 2025
State self-representation document — contains admissions of outstanding PIPs and data quality failures at time of federal funding approval

A50 — Iowa CCWIS VISION IAPD Part 2 (pp. 78–138) — December 8, 2025
Contains KinderTrack future interface listing and drug testing data system interface documentation

A51 — Iowa OCIO/DOM Enterprise IT Standards Page
Archived June 5, 2026 | Confirms CIO approval requirement | Approval process page returns HTTP 403 ACCESS DENIED

A52 — Iowa HHS Open Records Policy
Accessed June 5, 2026 | Establishes procedural framework evaluated against actual agency behavior in companion report Section 6

The following record was independently located by the petitioner via the Iowa HHS public website in February 2026 and is NOT part of the ORR

production set:

[Note: Iowa HHS Communication 626 (Drug Testing Practice, Policy, and Protocols — October 2, 2025) is not included as an attachment in this petition packet. It is independently available via the Iowa HHS public website and is cited by URL in Section 9 where relevant to the policy-practice gap analysis.]

18.6 DEFICIENCY CLASSIFICATION SUMMARY

Domains implicated:

Domain F — Fiscal & Procurement Accountability

Domain G — Federal Oversight History & Corrective Action

Domain H — Data Integrity & System Auditability

Primary Deficiency Categories:

F4 — Documentation & Data Integrity Deficiency

(No Data Governance Policy; PHI access without vetting; 403 finding; KinderTrack integration without remediation)

F5 — Repeat Findings Not Corrected

(Self-reporting approval structure replicates failed CFSR mechanism)

F7 — Fiscal Accountability & Procurement Transparency

(\$108.8M investment; CIO approval process inaccessible; NASPO vehicle)

F12 — Supervisory / Oversight Failure

(IT jurisdictional capture of federal CFSR reviewers)

F13 — Policy-Practice Implementation Gap

(PHI policies exist but contract lacks implementing provisions; fee demands inconsistent with open records policy standards)

18.7 AUDIT INQUIRY QUESTIONS

The following questions arise from the records produced and the companion report analysis, and are offered for consideration in scoping audit procedures:

(1) What documentation confirms CIO approval was obtained for the \$41.9M Google/Carahsoft contract, and what criteria were applied?

(2) What background check, fingerprinting, or equivalent vetting requirements were imposed on Google/Carahsoft personnel prior to PHI access?

(3) What independent verification was applied to Iowa's IAPD prior to the

Children's Bureau's conditional approval of \$45,786,250?

(4) What remediation of KinderTrack data accuracy failures has been completed prior to the planned CCWIS VISION integration?

(5) What controls govern the scope of data federal CFSR reviewers may access and export from Iowa HHS systems, and who administers those controls?

(6) What is the status of ORR #26-1536, and when will Iowa HHS produce responsive records regarding CCWIS data governance?

See also: Section 7 (IT jurisdictional capture — cross-reference 7.3(c)) |

Section 9 (Iowa HHS Comm. 626 — drug testing policy, cited by URL) | Section 10 (A21/A43 — KinderTrack) |

Section 13 (Systemic Failure Matrix — Domain H convergence) | Section 19 (Corrective Action Matrix)

CCWIS Companion Report: Part I (Transparency as an Audit Finding) |

Part II (Procurement & Contract Analysis) | Part III (Federal Approval) |

Part IV (PHI Access Controls & IT Jurisdictional Capture) |

Part V (Status & Outstanding Records)

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

End of Section 18 — Petition Body Version

Drafted June 5, 2026

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

AI assistance was used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim.